Bhattacharjee sensed his impatience and wrote to him, asking him to reconsider his plan to relocate the plant outside the state. But Ratan decided to brook no more delay. The orders for the car were piling up and customers were getting restless. The situation was fraught. After two years of facing insurmountable problems, he took the final call to leave the state on 3 October 2008.

The decision was taken in a meeting with Chief Minister Bhattacharjee and Commerce and Industry Minister Nirupam Sen. Ratan who was accompanied by Kant, expressed his extreme anguish at the unending hostility Tata Motors had faced. The chairman reiterated that 'there was no option but to move the project out of the state of West Bengal'. 'If somebody puts a gun to my head, you would either have to remove the gun or pull the trigger. I would not move my head. I think Ms Banerjee pulled the trigger,' Ratan said at a press conference announcing his decision the following day. In an emotional letter to Bhattacharjee, he expressed his extreme grief at how their dream of creating a milestone in the industrialization of the state had failed.

In a conversation with a car magazine, he said, 'We went to Bengal [with] a leap of faith to initiate the industrialization of the eastern part of India and I think we would have made a serious contribution to prosperity in that state had the conflict not happened.'

Modi's 'Suswagatam'

'At least nine Indian states have approached the Tata Group since Friday after Ratan Tata, its chairman, threatened to relocate the plant rather than expose his workers to violent protests, even if this meant forgoing the Rs 15bn ($343m) invested in the project,' wrote the *Financial Times*. But it was the speed with which Gujarat's chief minister, Narendra Modi, wooed the Tatas, that sealed the deal in the state's favour.

This was Modi's second term as the chief minister of the state, and he had become a legend for his speedy implementation of projects. Ratan quickly sent a team of top officials from Tata Motors to Gujarat for further discussions.

Within three days, the chief minister had found land and finalized the incentive package. The integrated project was designated on an area of about 1,100 acres. It impressed Ratan so much that he said in a TV